

Weber 1922 RG Notes

Weber, Max. “The Nature of Charismatic Authority and Its Routinization”
and

“The Pure Types of Legitimate Authority” [1922].

In *Max Weber on Charisma and Institution Building: Selected Papers*,
ed. S. N. Eisenstadt, pp. 46–65. Chicago: University of Chicago Press, 1968.
Excerpted from *The Theory of Social and Economic Organization* (1947),
trans. of
Wirtschaft und Gesellschaft (1922).

1 Main Idea

2 General Notes

- Stable domination or equilibrium order is *Herrschaft*, which requires a claim to legitimacy. Three possible such claims:
 1. Traditional authority – norms, cultural rules, dynasties, etc.
 2. Charismatic authority – devotion to a specific leader
 3. Legal-rational authority – legitimacy vested in institutions or rules
- Charismatic authority is extra-institutional and is largely unstable; it cannot survive for an extended period of time and instead must either adapt or die. This adaptation is routinization – charismatic authority must instead be shifted into embedded social and political structures, transforming charismatic authority into either traditional or legal-rational authority

3 Important Specific Factual Claims

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4 Connections

- Miller 1990: importance of charismatic leadership given that incentive structures cannot be perfectly constructed

5 My Critiques

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